

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Finding Reasoning Paths :

- 1 . **Un happiness â¸ Bip olar disorder â¸ Depression with man ia /h yp oman ia . **
- 2 . **Su ic idal ide ation â¸ Major depressive disorder â¸ Bip olar disorder . **
- 3 . **Feeling cursed â¸ Psych os omatic symptoms â¸ Bip olar disorder . **
- 4 . **Sleep disturbance â¸ Bip olar disorder . **
- 5 . **Hope lessness â¸ Major depressive disorder â¸ Bip olar disorder . **
- 6 . **Decre ased energy , concentration , and motivation â¸ Major depressive disorder â¸ Bip olar disorder . **
- 7 . **Su ic idal ide ation â¸ Major depressive disorder â¸ Bip olar disorder . **
- 8 . **Diss atisfaction with life â¸ Psych os omatic illness â¸ Bip olar disorder . **

Reasoning Process :

- 1 . **Key Symptoms Analysis : **
 - The patient reports **un happiness , suicidal ide ation , depression , rest lessness , and energy depletion** over the past two weeks . These symptoms suggest a depressive episode , possibly with significant mood changes or energy fluctuations .
 - Su ic idal ide ation and decreased energy /con centration are hallmark symptoms of **major depressive disorder (MDD)** .
 - The mention of **dis appointment , anger , frustration , hope lessness , guilt , and sadness** further supports a depressive diagnosis .
 - However , the presence of **rest lessness** and **amplified mood changes** raises the possibility of a manic or hyp oman ic episode , which are common in **b ip olar disorder** .
- 2 . **Predis posing Factors : **
 - The history of **fe eling cursed and believing in fate** could indicate a pre occupation with catastrophic events or psych os omatic illness , which is commonly seen in **b ip olar disorder** .
 - The **global feeling of failing** and **ex agger ated sadness** are consistent with depressive symptoms .
- 3 . **Differential Diagnosis : **
 - **Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) : **
 - Fits the clinical picture of depression , including sadness , energy depletion , and decreased motivation .
 - However , MDD does not typically involve manic or hyp oman ic episodes or psych os omatic symptoms .
 - **Bip olar Disorder : **
 - Fits the clinical picture of a depressive episode with **rest lessness , energy depletion , and psych os omatic symptoms** (e .g . , believing in fate) .
 - Man ic or hyp oman ic episodes could explain the rest lessness and amplified mood changes .
 - **Psych os omatic Ill ness : **
 - Could explain the physical symptoms (e .g . , energy depletion , feeling tired) but does not account for the psychological distress or manic /h yp oman ic symptoms .
- 4 . **Integration of Symptoms : **
 - The patient 's depressive symptoms align with MDD .
 - However , the presence of manic /h yp oman ic symptoms (e .g . , rest lessness , psych os omatic belief in fate) makes a diagnosis of **b ip olar disorder** more likely .
 - The depressive episode in bipolar disorder can sometimes be classified as **double depression** , where there are two episodes of major depressive disorder separated by periods of normal or only mildly elevated mood .

Conclusion :

The patient is likely to show **b ip olar disorder** with **double depression** as one of his conditions .

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The patient is at risk for double depression .

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